

Potent Fastlane #1: The Internet

The most potent interstate is an Internet business. The Internet has made more millionaires in the last decade than any other medium out there. The Internet has, and is, destroying old hard-line industries such as travel agents, stockbrokers, newspapers, and magazines. The Internet is the shark of the Fastlane.

The Internet is where I found my fortune and it is one reason why I declined my opportunity to own a limousine company. The Internet is the best Fastlane available, because it immediately obeys the Five Commandments to the Fastlane, assuming a need-based premise. It naturally scales to a worldwide audience, it systematizes to automation via computer systems, it is a medium you can control (unfortunately, most don't), and its barriers are still strong enough to prevent "everyone" from entry.

Internet business models (roads) fall into seven broad categories:

1) Subscription-based

Offer users access to data, information, or software, and charge a monthly fee. Data can be leads, sales information, a proprietary database, or good old-fashioned pornography. When 10,000 people pay you \$9.95 per month for your information, you're balling the Fastlane!

When I owned my company, I paid for many Web services, all subscription-based. From data analytics (who is visiting my site?) to affiliate management (who wants to offer my service?). One particular company ran a Web-site-monitoring service that kept track of Web site uptime. On its home page it advertised how many clients it monitored. At the time, it listed "20,000 clients served," and I was paying \$50 per month for service. Assuming my fee was average, $20,000 \times \$50 = \$1,000,000$ in gross revenue—PER MONTH. This is a perfect example of an Internet business system in which the business is the system. No products. No shipping. No headaches. I'd speculate that this Web site enjoys margins of 75% and nets in the \$750,000 range, per month. How quickly would you become a millionaire earning \$750,000/month? Or, would you rather save \$200/month from your \$45K/year salary? The disparaging field of play is laughable.

Examples of subscription sites are RealtyTrac.com and LoopNet.com.

2) Content-based

Content-based models are online news magazines and blogs that disseminate information to a particular niche or industry. These services provide content for free consumption and sell advertising to parties who want to reach those eyeballs. My Fastlane Forum can be considered a content-based revenue model. I consider content-based revenue models the most difficult for success because entry barriers have significantly declined and its success is predicated on high